Andre Gerecke

Senior Digital Transformation Manager

AI strategy, enablement and implementation

andre.gerecke@rwe.com | Portfolio | October 2026

PROFILE

Digital transformation professional with 16+ years of experience and functional AI leadership in renewables. I shape AI transformation at OPEA, supporting adoption across business functions from use-case ideation and experimentation through implementation, scaling and impact tracking. I developed an AI Prompting Framework and build capability through hands-on workshops, Copilot enablement and coaching. With business, IT/OT and technology partners, I turn opportunities into solutions aligned with enterprise architecture and operational needs.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- AI strategy translation and scaling: business-led use cases, adoption and measurable impact
- Innovation and experimentation: ideation, proof of concept, rapid iteration and validation
- AI enablement portfolio and delivery: hands-on workshops, rapid prototyping and hackathons
- Business-led delivery: persona implementations, benefit tracking and operational integration
- Digital transformation and agile project management: Scrum, Design Thinking and Lean Startup
- Cross-functional collaboration, workshop facilitation and coaching: business, IT/OT and delivery teams

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Digital Transformation Manager

RWE Renewables Europe & Australia GmbH, Essen | October 2023 - Present

- Conceived the OPEA AI Strategy 2026 and supporting AI enablement portfolio, defining a structured approach to scaling AI adoption and connecting practical capability building with business-value creation.
- Shaped AI-centred business-process redesign through Design Thinking-inspired workshops with Development EU, Engineering and Operations, contributing to NPV.OptimAIzer, an AI lighthouse integrating turbine selection, layout optimisation, wind-resource assessment and financial modelling to support project-value optimisation.
- Designed the 2027 OPEA AI Enablement and Scaling Concept, combining a four-level AI maturity model, six-phase methodology and targeted six-to-eight-week AI Value Waves with practical use-case implementation and evidence-based impact measurement; defined a scaling roadmap through 2029.
- Designed and delivered business-specific, hands-on Copilot workshops and rapid-prototyping sessions, reaching 700+ colleagues with practical approaches to applying AI in business processes, including opportunities to create Copilot agents.
- Established a cross-functional network of 28 AI Champions to support adoption through peer learning, reusable prompts and agents, use-case identification, and contributions to workshops and hackathons.
- Co-organised and delivered a Microsoft 365 Copilot and Copilot Studio hackathon in September 2026 with Microsoft, bringing together approximately 50 business participants across five groups to develop early prototypes, including a UK Control Room shift-handover agent workflow, with structured follow-up pathways.
- Supported and guided business teams from ideation through creation and implementation of AI agents, including a Procurement Support Agent that compares market developments with internal procurement information and generates recommendations.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Senior Digital Expert

RWE Renewables GmbH, Essen
August 2019 - September 2023

- Led digital initiatives delivering high-value MVPs using Lean Startup, Design Thinking and Scrum.
- Founded and led the Process Optimization Factory to automate repetitive processes, including Azure Document Intelligence for PDF data extraction.
- Developed an Agile Innovation Framework for scouting and evaluating digital opportunities; provided agile coaching across business teams.

Senior Manager Mobile Solutions

GS1 Germany GmbH, Cologne
August 2013 - August 2019

- Provided strategy consulting in Digital & Mobile Commerce: couponing, location-based marketing, smart packaging, conversational commerce and AR.
- Led mobile commerce projects in FMCG and retail; conducted market analysis and developed project concepts.

International Project Manager

Venista Ventures GmbH & Co. KG, Cologne
June 2010 - July 2013

- Managed international roll-outs of mobile services and apps using agile project management.
- Drove product-management improvements across the app portfolio; evaluated business models and the competitive landscape.

EDUCATION

Post Graduate Program in Artificial Intelligence & Machine Learning (Business Applications)

The University of Texas at Austin
May 2025 - February 2026

Python foundations; machine learning; advanced ML (ensembles and hyperparameter tuning); neural networks; computer vision (CNNs); NLP with generative AI (Transformers, RAG and prompt engineering); multimodal GenAI; model deployment; MLOps (CI/CD, monitoring and retraining); recommendation systems. Hands-on learning with 7 projects and 40+ case studies; mentored by industry experts from Microsoft, SAP, IBM and Apple.

M.A., Marketing Management

European University of Applied Sciences (EUFH), Cologne
2015 - 2017

B.Sc., International Business

Pforzheim University of Applied Sciences; double degree with ESCE Paris
2006 - 2010

CERTIFICATIONS

- Professional Scrum Master (PSM I)
- Professional Agile Leadership (PAL I)
- Certified Agile Coach
- Project Management DIN 69901; ISO 21500

SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

AI and ML methods	Generative AI (LLMs), prompt engineering and persona/agent design (Expert); RAG use cases (Expert); MLOps (CI/CD, monitoring and retraining); Python, TensorFlow, PyTorch and LangChain.
AI platforms and development	ChatGPT, Microsoft Copilot, Claude, Gemini and DeepSeek (Expert); GitHub Copilot, OpenAI Codex and Claude Code (Expert); Microsoft Copilot Studio (Advanced).
Workflow automation	n8n and Make (Advanced); Microsoft Power Platform and Power Automate (Advanced).
Collaboration and design	Mural and Miro (Expert); Figma (Basic).
Project and productivity tools	Azure DevOps, Airtable and Confluence (Advanced); Microsoft Office and Teams (Expert).
Languages	German: native. English: business fluent (C1). French: business fluent (C1).